Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Ty Mynydd

Ty Mynydd, Longford Court, Neath, SA10 7HN

01792326824

www.autism.org.uk

The inspection visits for this service took place between 02/07/2026 and 14/07/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	National Autistic Society
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care
Registered places:	6
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Requires Improvement
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Ty Mynydd is located in Neath and provides personal care and support to people. It is close to a number of community facilities which can be easily accessed from the service. The service has made significant progress since the previous inspection and people are now benefiting from improved outcomes across the service. There are notable improvements in care planning, staffing and staff support, governance systems and environmental safety.

Well-being at the service is good and people receive personalised care and support that reflects their individual needs, preferences and aspirations. People have access to a wider range of meaningful opportunities and are supported by care staff who understand their communication and support needs.

Improvements have been made to care and support and personal plans are detailed, regularly reviewed and provide staff with clear guidance to support people safely and effectively. Further improvements are required to ensure all records are completed consistently.

The environment is good. Improvements identified at the previous inspection relating to health and safety monitoring and environmental checks have been addressed. People live in accommodation that supports their comfort, safety and well-being.

Leadership and management is good and governance systems have been strengthened. Staff supervision and support arrangements have improved, and reliance on agency staff has reduced significantly. Care staff spoke positively about the culture within the service and described management as supportive and approachable.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People live healthily and safely with control over their lives. Since the last inspection, Ty Mynydd has made significant improvements in supporting people to achieve positive well-being outcomes. People are actively involved in making choices about their daily lives, including meals, activities and how they spend their time. A varied programme of meaningful activities is now in place, with people regularly accessing their local community and enjoying opportunities tailored to their interests. People's communication needs are understood and supported well. Information is available in accessible formats, and the service demonstrates a positive commitment to ensuring people receive information in ways they can understand. We saw examples of personalised approaches to support people with specific communication needs. The service is working towards the Welsh active offer. A number of care staff employed are Welsh speakers, and the service will provide documentation in Welsh if requested.

There are systems in place to ensure people are safe and protected from abuse and neglect. Care staff receive safeguarding training and those spoken with have a clear understanding of safeguarding procedures and are confident in raising concerns. Notifications and incidents have been appropriately reported, investigated and reviewed, with evidence of lessons learned and improvements implemented.

Safe and healthy relationships are promoted, and people are encouraged to maintain meaningful relationships with those who are important to them. Records evidenced regular contact with family members and relatives provided positive feedback about the quality of care and communication from the service. A relative told us *"staff are kind, knowledgeable and caring".* Care staff know people well and demonstrate a good understanding of their individual communication styles, preferences and support needs. Personal plans reflect people's social networks, interests and aspirations, helping staff provide personalised support. Records seen show people spending time in their local community and we saw people accessing the community throughout the day of the inspection. This demonstrates a commitment by the provider to ensuring people lead fulfilling lives and remain connected to the people and places that matter to them.

The accommodation supports people to achieve their well-being outcomes. The environment at Ty Mynydd has improved considerably since the previous inspection and now provides a safe, comfortable and welcoming place for people to live. Improvement works are underway, including bathroom upgrades and enhancements to external areas, demonstrating the provider's commitment to continuous development. Environmental audits, maintenance checks and safety monitoring systems are in place and being completed consistently.

Care & Support — Requires Improvement

People receive the quality of care and support they need to achieve their personal outcomes**.** Improvements have been made since the previous inspection and people's personal plans are now more detailed, outcome-focused and supported by individual risk assessments. Records demonstrate a better understanding of people's communication needs, specific support requirements and health conditions. However, improvements have not yet been embedded consistently across the service. While some care records are comprehensive and evidenced good-quality support, we found gaps in daily recordings, nutritional monitoring and personal care documentation for one person. Activity records also show periods where engagement was limited or not clearly evidenced. The inconsistencies in recording and evidence of care delivery mean we cannot be fully assured that good outcomes are achieved consistently for everyone living at the service. Outcomes for people require improvement because records do not consistently evidence care and support is provided in line with individuals' assessed needs, personal outcomes and preferences, and we expect the provider to make improvements. We have discussed this with the provider who is committed to making continued improvements.

People are protected from harm and abuse. Safeguarding systems are in place and staff demonstrate an understanding of their responsibilities to recognise and report concerns. Staff described management as *"supportive"* and told us they feel confident raising concerns and managers would take appropriate action. Care staff training records show they receive safeguarding training which is updated routinely. Some areas of practice indicate that safeguarding and risk management arrangements require further strengthening. We noted that the front gate was unsecured on arrival to the service, despite people living at the home requiring support to remain safe. The provider has assured us measures will be taken to prevent the re-occurrence of this.

There are systems in place to ensure medication is safely managed. Medication management has improved since the last inspection. Medication audits are undertaken, staff are trained and competency assessed, and previous concerns regarding medication administration have largely been addressed. However, on the day of inspection we saw a medication administration authorisation record was out of date and there were no review dates seen. The provider has since obtained an updated authorisation. We also found gaps in medication temperature monitoring records. Outcomes for people may be compromised because medication management systems require strengthening and we expect the provider to make improvements. The provider acknowledges these concerns and demonstrates a commitment to address them.

People's risk of infection is minimised. The service is clean, tidy and generally well maintained. Improvements identified at the previous inspection regarding environmental monitoring have been addressed, reducing identified infection control risks. Staff have access to personal protective equipment and training compliance has improved.

Environment

Good

People live in an environment with appropriate and well-maintained facilities and equipment to help them achieve their well-being outcomes while identifying, mitigating and reducing health and safety risks**.** People live in a comfortable, spacious and homely environment that is well suited to their individual needs. The service provides a range of communal and private spaces that promote choice, independence and well-being. Bedrooms are personalised and reflect people's interests and preferences. Communal areas are welcoming, clean and accessible, enabling people to spend time together or independently according to their wishes. The service continues to invest in improving the environment, with refurbishment works underway, including upgrades to a bathroom and enhancements to outdoor areas. Improvements to the garden and boundary areas are supporting safer access to outdoor space whilst maintaining opportunities for recreation and relaxation.

The service is clean, clutter free and well-presented. The atmosphere throughout the home is calm and homely, enabling people to spend time in ways that suit their individual preferences and routines. There is a clear commitment to providing people with a pleasant place to live that supports both their comfort and well-being outcomes. Photographs, personal belongings and decorative features help create surroundings that reflect the interests of people who live there. Equipment and furnishings are suitable for purpose and support people to remain comfortable and independent.

Effective arrangements are in place to ensure the environment remains safe, well maintained and fit for purpose. Since the previous inspection, significant improvements have been made in relation to health and safety monitoring and environmental oversight. The provider has addressed previous concerns regarding inconsistent health and safety checks, with evidence of routine maintenance and monitoring systems now being completed regularly and effectively. Environmental audits, maintenance checks and servicing arrangements provide assurance that facilities and equipment are maintained in good working order. Emergency procedures are well established, and care staff have clear guidance on supporting people safely in the event of an incident or emergency.

The home benefits from dedicated maintenance support, enabling repairs and improvements to be addressed promptly. We spoke to a member of the maintenance team who has a good understanding of the service and feels supported by the leadership team in addressing repairs and planned improvements. Records show checks relating to environmental safety, infection prevention and equipment maintenance are being completed and monitored. We found health and safety risks are appropriately identified and managed, contributing to a safer environment for people and care staff.

Leadership & Management — Good

People are supported to achieve their outcomes because the service provider has effective organisational arrangements, governance and oversight to ensure smooth operations and high-quality care. Since the previous inspection, Ty Mynydd has undergone a significant period of positive transformation, driven by strengthened leadership, improved oversight and a clear commitment to achieving sustainable improvements for people. The service has responded well to Priority Action Notices issued following the previous inspection, with leaders demonstrating a strong understanding of the areas requiring improvement and implementing effective action plans to address them.

Governance systems are focused on monitoring quality, identifying trends and driving service development. Responsible Individual visits are thorough and reflective, evidencing clear analysis of practice and meaningful actions to improve outcomes for people. Quality of Care Reviews are completed within required timescales and increasingly focus on evaluating the lived experience of people using the service, with feedback from relatives helping to shape ongoing improvements. The introduction of robust monitoring systems has strengthened oversight of care records, health and safety checks, staff performance and service delivery. The management team demonstrate a clear vision for the service and discussed with us achievements and progress made as well as areas still requiring development.

Care staff have the necessary expertise, skills, and qualifications to meet people's care and support needs. Safe recruitment practices are in place, with robust pre-employment and background checks completed prior to staff starting work at Ty Mynydd. Ongoing checks are also undertaken to ensure staff remain suitable to work within the service. The service has worked proactively to strengthen workforce stability and reduce dependence on agency staff. Recruitment initiatives have resulted in new staff joining the service, helping to provide people with greater continuity and consistency of care. We saw there are regular team meetings held, and staff have opportunities to discuss practice and service developments. Significant improvements have been made in relation to staff training, supervision and appraisal processes, addressing concerns identified at the previous inspection.

Staff receive consistent support, guidance and performance oversight, enabling them to develop their knowledge and confidence to meet people's needs effectively. Care staff spoke positively about working at Ty Mynydd and consistently described a supportive and inclusive culture. One member of staff told us, *"The managers are supportive and if I have any complaints, I have a response,"* whilst another described the service as *"fantastic… a good place to work."*

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

The table(s) below show the area(s) for priority action and/or those for improvement we have identified.

Summary of Areas for Improvement	Date identified
People's well-being outcomes may be compromised because care records do not consistently evidence that care and support is provided in line with individuals' assessed needs, personal outcomes and preferences. The provider must ensure records accurately reflect the care and support delivered and demonstrate how people's needs and outcomes are met.	02/07/26

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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